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Species Name:

Rhimetals/Rufus

Leader: Wofrrs, The Crowned Wing

> *"We do not conquer. We correct."*

Homeworld: *Aeiralux*

A shimmering atmosphere-heavy planet of floating spires, crystal canopies, and electromagnetic updrafts. The Rhimetals' cities are suspended in the upper stratosphere, far above the planet's chaotic surface storms.

Appearance:

The Rhimetals resemble statuesque humanoids with metallic skin tones ranging from silver-blue to gold-white. Two enormous, feathered wings extend from their backs — though these aren't just for flight. Their wings function like solar receptors and communication arrays, glowing faintly when transmitting thoughts through their **hive consciousness**.
Their eyes lack pupils and shimmer like polished opal. Despite their celestial look, their movement is swift, cold, and exact — every gesture seems choreographed by unseen will.

Core Traits & Abilities:

- **Hive Mind Network**
  All Rhimetals are mentally connected. Wofrrs governs the collective directly, issuing commands with perfect synchronization. If Wofrrs is blocked or suppressed, command efficiency collapses until a new node is established.

- **Supersonic Flight**
  Rhimetals are among the fastest species in the skies. On the battlefield, they can reposition rapidly, strike suddenly, or avoid danger with incredible agility. However, they must rest or recharge between bursts.

- **Limited Telepathy**
  They can "read" the surface thoughts and emotions of lesser minds (non-hive beings) in close proximity. Useful for diplomacy, manipulation, or anticipating tactical

intentions. But it's blocked by certain technologies or mental barriers.

- **Kind but Firm Ideology**
  The Rhimetals view themselves as *galactic custodians* — not conquerors, but enforcers of peace and order. They often act as arbitrators or intervene when others spiral into chaos. Compassion guides them, but defiance is not tolerated.
  Their motto: *Mercy to the innocent. Clarity to the defiant.*

Balance Mechanics:

- ✅ **Strengths**:
  - Extremely fast air mobility
  - Tactical mind-reading advantage
  - Perfect unit coordination under Wofrrs
  - Diplomatic bonus due to reputation for fairness
- ❌ **Weaknesses**:
  - If Wofrrs is captured, jammed, or killed, their hive connection frays (units act independently with reduced efficiency)
  - Flight troops are vulnerable indoors or underground
  - Reluctant to strike first — bound by ethical doctrine, which might delay aggressive action unless provoked
  - Physically lighter; ground combat is not their strength

Gameplay Niche:

The *Rhimetals* are **elite skirmishers and peacekeepers**, excelling at surgical strikes, rapid deployment, and psychological warfare. They're best played as **controllers of tempo** — dictating where, when, and how conflict unfolds.

Species Name:

Gabagoonians/Cohen

Leader: Eileen Ulick, The Soprano-Savant

> *"You come to me, on the day of my dinner? … Sit down. Eat something."*

Homeworld: Meatballia Prima

A humid, protein-rich moon orbiting a gas giant, covered in dense fungal forests, salt flats, and swamps that naturally grow *capacola vines*. Most of Gabagoonian civilization is centered around food courts, worship-canteens, and holovision temples constantly re-airing **The Sopranos**.

Appearance:

Short, wide, and squishy, the Gabagoonians stand 4 feet tall and 2 feet wide, shaped like upright ovals with stubby arms and hover-assisted feet. Their faces consist of wide, expressive eyes and a mouth that stretches almost ear to ear.
They waddle — until they eat enough *capacola*. Then, their bodies shimmer with oily power, bulking up disproportionately, and their pupils spiral into Tony-shaped glyphs.

Core Traits & Abilities:

- **Capacola Surge**
  Consuming *capacola* — either as a stored resource or battlefield supply — temporarily grants Gabagoonians massive strength and **telekinetic powers**.
  The effect scales with how much is eaten, but they crash hard after use (slower movement, lowered defense, and general grumpiness).

- **Cultural Obsession: *The Sopranos***
  All Gabagoonians revere The Sopranos as a foundational myth. Viewing episodes restores morale, unlocks special buffs (e.g., *"Woke Up This Morning"* = first strike bonus), and improves diplomatic standing with comedic or TV-obsessed species.
  However, if The Sopranos are insulted or deleted from a planet's network — instant **Galactic Vendetta**.

- **Tactical Gooning**
  They can enter a trance-like state ("full goon mode"), which increases defense and psychic resistance, but leaves them temporarily oblivious to diplomacy or long-term goals. Use it for sieges or unrelenting pursuits.

Balance Mechanics:

- ✅ **Strengths**:
  - Surprising burst damage via capacola-fueled transformations
  - Unpredictable telekinetic attacks
  - High morale when binge-watching
  - Unique diplomacy tree with media-savvy races
  - Very loyal — they stick to allies like cling wrap
- ❌ **Weaknesses**:
  - Short range and slow baseline movement
  - Need to maintain *capacola supply chains* (they'll sulk without it)
  - Easily distracted by reruns and fictional drama
  - Post-capacola crash renders units nearly useless for 1–2 turns
  - Start wars over sitcom rankings

Gameplay Niche:

The *Gabagoonians* are **momentum-based brawlers** — silly-looking but scary when fully stocked and agitated. Great for mid-game surprise attacks, defensive meme-based diplomacy, and **food-fueled power spikes**.

Species Name:

Infernoids/Martijn

Leader: Mulgar, The Pyreborn Tyrant

> *"Purity is flame. The rest is ash."*

Homeworld: Pyrothar

A writhing volcanic hellscape cloaked in eternal ash clouds and bathed in rivers of molten rock. Pyrothar's tectonic instability and oxygen-thin, hyperthermal atmosphere have forged the Infernoids into living weapons—predators of pain, fire, and fury.

Appearance & Physiology:

- **Exoskeletal Armor:** Obsidian plates regenerate as they move, glowing with inner magma. Cracks in combat signal their rising fury.
- **Thermal Vision:** See clearly through ash, smoke, and walls by tracking heat signatures.
- **Fireblood:** A volatile liquid that ignites on contact with oxygen. Can be weaponized in melee or through explosive deaths.
- **Maw of Cinders:** Serrated jaws that chew rock and metal; capable of a plasma breath burst at close range.

Subtypes:

1. **Standard Infernoids (6–8 ft):** Agile frontline shock troops—strong, fast, and heat-immune.
2. **Brutes (8–12 ft):** Towering, slower units with heavy melee capabilities.
3. **Elder Infernoids (15–30 ft):** Rare titan-class units; slow but nearly indestructible, feared across the stars.

Behavior & Ideology:

- **Pain is Honor:** Pain is a holy sacrament. Wounded units may gain buffs the longer they stay in combat.
- **No Fear of Death:** High morale in hopeless odds; suiciding to cause fireblood detonations is a core tactic.
- **Xenocidal Zeal:** Enslavement or incineration—there is no middle ground. Diplomacy is seen as weakness, except for rare exploitation.

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ **Strengths:**
  - **Extreme Heat Resistance & Environmental Immunity** (ideal for hostile planets or fire-based traps)
  - **Morale Inversion:** Take *less morale damage* the more damage they take.
  - **Fireblood Detonations:** Deaths cause AoE damage—position them well and your losses become weapons.
  - **Titan Units:** The Elders (rare but devastating) function as siege-beasts or planetary-scale deterrents.
- ❌ **Weaknesses:**
  - **Tech Limitations:** Primitive in diplomacy, stealth, or information warfare. All tech is fire or brute-force themed.
  - **Resource Gluttons:** Require high thermal energy and exotic minerals; struggle in cold or resource-poor systems.
  - **Diplomatic Pariah:** Almost all factions view them with fear or hatred. Hard to form alliances—most players may want to exterminate or avoid them.
  - **Vulnerable to Air/Aquatic Attacks:** No flyers, minimal space navy unless forged late-game.

Gameplay Niche:

The *Infernoids* are **planetary juggernauts and attrition-based crusaders**. On land, they are nearly unstoppable once established. Ideal for players who love overwhelming force, **sacrificial swarm tactics**, and tactical destruction rather than long-term peace or trade.

Species Name

Movanites/David

Leader: Cedeti the Third, Grand Komptroller of the Stampede

> *"Peace is our policy. But so is trampling."*

Homeworld: Graviton Vale

An enormous super-Earth rich in rare minerals and dense metals. Its crushing gravity has shaped everything—from architecture to biology. Movanite cities are built into canyons and caverns where movement is optimized and pressure equalized.

Appearance & Physiology:

- **Quadruped Centaur Forms:** Compact and powerful, Movanites stand about 4 feet tall, with four stocky legs and two dexterous arms. Despite their size, their muscular density allows for incredible acceleration and balance.
- **Dense Muscle Structure:** Evolved under heavy gravity, Movanites are deceptively fast and can carry far more than other species of similar size.
- **Chitin-Plated Backs:** Offer natural defense against blunt-force trauma and aerial attacks.

Behavior & Ideology:

- **Peaceful Majority:** Culturally calm, philosophical, and bureaucratic. Most disputes are resolved through debate, mediation, or subcommittee.
- **"Fuck Around and Find Out" Protocol:** A constitutional clause that allows for **total militarized retaliation** if a foreign power crosses certain lines (e.g., mining rights, spitting in Cedeti's direction).
- **Massive Population:** Their sheer numbers allow for endless waves of laborers, settlers, or soldiers. There's literally a *form* for everything—and someone has filled it

out.

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ **Strengths:**
  - **Mass Mobilization:** Can field huge armies at low cost. Units build fast, replenish faster.
  - **Speed & Swarming:** Ground units are incredibly fast for their size. Ideal for flanking, overwhelming, or chasing.
  - **Industrial Powerhouse:** Start with abundant minerals and strong infrastructure bonuses.
  - **High Morale When Provoked:** Retaliatory wars give combat bonuses and economic buffs.
- ❌ **Weaknesses:**
  - **Low Individual Power:** One unit ≠ much. Success depends on **mass coordination**.
  - **Command Bottlenecks:** Too many Movanites means bureaucratic gridlock—limits on simultaneous expansion or production unless tech is researched.
  - **Vulnerable to Attrition or Traps:** Swarms can be wiped out by AoE or clever terrain use.
  - **Overpopulation Events:** If left unchecked, pop booms can cause instability or food crises.

Gameplay Niche:

The *Movanites* are **horde-builders and economic titans**, built for **overwhelming numbers and tactical swarm mechanics**. Great for players who enjoy rapid expansion, battlefield humor, and turning bureaucratic overreach into galactic dominance.

Species Name:

Leo-pantheri/Lolo

Leader: T'Kharan Maul, The Harmonious Roar

> *"Be not the sheep. Be the lion. But always remember to breathe first*

Homeworld: Savarr'Tel

A majestic world of endless golden grasslands, ancient stone citadels, and storm-lit mesas. Vast starlit plains hold the echoes of duels long past, while underground sanctuaries hum with the sound of telescopes, chant, and string instruments. It is a planet where ritual and research intertwine.

Appearance & Physiology:

- ***Lion-esque Humanoids:*** *Tall (6.5–8 feet), muscular, and imposing, with digitigrade legs, long manes, and fur tones ranging from obsidian black to burning gold.*
- ***Eyes of Twin Suns:*** *Irises glow faintly in the dark — a trait passed from celestial alignment rituals at birth.*
- ***Clawed but Cultured:*** *Their claws are retracted during peace rituals and extended in battle; a visible declaration of intent.*
- ***Voices Carry Authority:*** *Their low, resonant voices can be used to project calm—or paralyze foes in fear.*

Society & Ideology:

- ***Ritual Combat as Rite:*** *Every Leo-pantheri undergoes ritual duels not for blood, but to remember the chaos of the universe and master restraint. Combat is seen as a mirror for truth, not domination.*
- ***Art as Duty:*** *Every citizen contributes to the cultural legacy—through painting, storytelling, architecture, or sacred science.*
- ***Unified Theology & Science:*** *They believe that uncovering the laws of nature is itself a divine act. Equations are sung in temples; particle accelerators hum beside*

prayer wheels.

- ***Honor-Bound Diplomats:*** *War is their last resort—used only when all reason has been exhausted or if a moral imperative demands intervention.*

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ ***Strengths:***
  - ***Honor System Buffs:*** *Gain bonuses when keeping treaties, avoiding betrayals, or winning defensive wars.*
  - ***Dual-Tech Trees:*** *Their tech tree has both Scientific and Spiritual paths that converge mid-game into powerful hybrid techs.*
  - ***Cultural Influence:*** *Boosts in unity, morale, and loyalty from art and philosophy structures.*
  - ***Ritual Champions:*** *Elite duelists or commanders can be fielded with unique buffs from personal combat trials.*
- ❌ ***Weaknesses:***
  - ***Refuse First Strike Penalty:*** *Major morale loss and reputation damage if they start an unjustified war.*
  - ***Honor Lock:*** *May be unable to use certain underhanded strategies (e.g., assassination, backstabbing diplomacy) without losing faction-wide bonuses.*
  - ***Tech Requires Balance:*** *Focusing too heavily on science without culture—or vice versa—can lock out higher-tier upgrades.*
  - ***Expensive Units:*** *Units are elite and well-trained, but few in number and costly to replace.*

Gameplay Niche:

The Leo-pantheri are ***philosopher-kings and tactical diplomats****, suited for players who enjoy playing with moral weight, cultural superiority, and delayed but devastating military precision. They reward patience, elegance, and decisive action when provoked.*

Species Name:

The Buthari/ Hisham

Leader: No formal leader — governed by the Council of Five

> *"Come vibe. But never confuse sharing the fire with being part of the flame."*

Homeworld: Jabal

A rugged planet of towering mountain ranges, emerald valleys, and mist-covered plateaus. The atmosphere is laced with natural psychoactive compounds, and sacred trails wind through the peaks, leading to ancient tribal altars. Locals live in carved-out cliff dwellings and grow mind-altering flora in terrace farms. Every sunrise begins with ritual smoke; every sunset ends in communion with Mother Jabal—their living, breathing god-planet.

Appearance & Physiology:

- ***Mountain-Animal Adapted Bodies:*** *Buthari have muscular, agile bodies with traits adapted from native mountain fauna—goatlike legs, snow-leopard agility, bear-like resilience—but their faces remain distinctly human, often adorned with gold jewelry and tribal tattoos.*

- ***Eternal Health:*** *Despite constant drug use, they suffer no negative side effects—somehow biologically tuned to psychoactive chemicals.*

- ***Aura of Privilege:*** *Every Buthari—man or woman—moves like royalty. Their posture, fashion, and gaze say, "I was born chosen."*

Society & Culture:

- ***Tribal Communalism:*** *A deeply interdependent system—each tribe works for the whole, yet every individual remains proudly self-sufficient.*

- ***Closed Social Order:*** *Outsiders may be tolerated, even celebrated, but never truly accepted. You can visit, maybe trade, but you will never belong.*

- ***Spiritual Narcotic Rites:*** *Daily weed ceremonies promote unity, while ayahuasca visions guide decision-making. The plants are seen as gifts from Jabal.*

- ***The Council of Five:*** *Super-powered defenders, each representing a sacred mountain beast:*

    1. ***Gharnuq*** *(Ibex) – Unmatched agility, cosmic leaping strikes.*

    2. ***Barra*** *(Snow Panther) – Invisibility and silent infiltration.*

    3. ***Zughra*** *(Fire Bear) – Tank-like strength and radiant flame body.*

    4. ***Rahla*** *(Hawk-Deer) – Flight and vision into alternate futures.*

    5. ***Thamir*** *(Rock Serpent) – Burrowing sabotage and seismic control.*

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ ***Strengths:***

    - ***Diplomatic Mastery:*** *Gain unique options for influencing, bribing, or destabilizing other factions from within. Funding insurgencies or radical parties is cheaper and more effective.*

    - ***Chemical Immunity:*** *Immune to narcotic-based debuffs, plagues, and hallucination weapons.*

    - ***Unyielding Defense:*** *When defending their homeworld or sacred territory, receive major combat buffs.*

    - ***The Five Champions:*** *Once per galactic cycle, can deploy one or all of the Five in planetary defense or targeted missions.*

- ❌ ***Weaknesses:***

    - ***Never Aggressors:*** *Cannot declare war first unless directly attacked or their rites are violated (e.g., orbital bombardment during a smoke ritual).*

    - ***Socially Xenophobic:*** *Can't form true alliances—limited to trade or temporary pacts. Diplomatic bonuses do not apply to close integration.*

    - ***Rigid Identity Politics:*** *Internal faction conflicts over "who's pure enough" can cause unrest in multicultural colonies.*

Gameplay Niche:

*The Buthari are **master manipulators and fortress-hold mystics**, ideal for players who want to dominate through culture, destabilization, and defense. They won't conquer you—they'll convince your people to do it for them. But push too far, and you'll awaken a pantheon of high-as-hell warrior gods ready to tear you limb from limb.*

Species Name:

Sarrak/Sil

Leader: Domina Scalex, First Fang of the Godswamp

> *"Strength is sacred. The weak are fuel. The Swamp decides."*

Homeworld: Gor'Zhul

A dense, steaming planet of vast bioluminescent swamps, vine-choked trees, and carnivorous flora. The very air tastes like iron and spice. Ancient temples and military fortresses rise from the mud, adorned with bones and glowing glyphs praising Vorr'Thul — the One Swamp God. The entire planet hums with natural biotechnology and predatory energy.

Appearance & Physiology:

- ***Crocodilian Build:*** *The Sarrak resemble 7–10 foot tall humanoid crocodiles, with thick armored scales and jaws built to crush stone.*
- ***Genetic Hair Strips:*** *A single strip of oily, mullet-like hair runs from skull to tail—bioengineered as a pride symbol and tribal identifier.*
- ***Swamp Juice Infusion:*** *Warriors are blessed with "Divine Serum", a glowing, enzyme-rich combat steroid harvested from Swamproots and blessed in ritual. It increases size, aggression, and pain immunity during battle—but causes hallucinations if overused.*

Society & Culture:

- ***Monotheistic Fanaticism:*** *All believe in Vorr'Thul, the living essence of the Swamp. His will is interpreted through war, weather, and mutation.*

- ***Imperial-Slave Structure:*** *Their society mirrors a* ***Roman military empire****, complete with legions, senatorial priests, slave economies, and gladiatorial trials.*

- ***Racist, Conquest-Driven:*** *Non-Sarrak are either worthy of conquest or worthy of chains. Rare exceptions are granted only after extreme loyalty—and even then, never true equality.*

- ***Spartan Upbringing:*** *Sarrak children are raised in mud arenas, trained to kill or die before they reach maturity.*

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ ***Strengths:***
  - ***Military Overdrive:*** *Buffed melee units via Swamp Juice. Extremely aggressive frontline warriors with regeneration.*
  - ***Slave Economy:*** *Conquered populations are used as cheap labor or expendable troops. Fast infrastructure growth in post-conquest zones.*
  - ***Religious Cohesion:*** *Morale never drops due to war weariness. High resistance to psychological attacks or culture flips.*
  - ***Natural Terrain Advantage:*** *Unmatched in jungle/swamp biomes, where they receive stealth and ambush bonuses.*
- ❌ ***Weaknesses:***
  - ***Diplomatic Isolation:*** *Few factions will ally with them—religious fanaticism and racism make long-term diplomacy nearly impossible.*
  - ***Swamp Dependency:*** *Outside swamp environments, many buffs are lost or require large investments to simulate conditions.*
  - ***Juice Withdrawal:*** *Units overusing Swamp Juice may suffer mental instability or hallucination-based debuffs if not rested or managed.*
  - ***Rebellion Risk:*** *Slave-heavy colonies are prone to uprising, especially when far from the homeworld or lacking overseers.*

Gameplay Niche:

*The Sarrak are a **relentless war machine**, meant for players who want to play as the ultimate **conquest-based faction**. They don't win hearts—they break them. But if you're outnumbered and out-teched, watch out… a single Sarrak legion in full juice-rage can **cut through entire civilizations** before they feel tired.*

Species Name:

Kaer'Ruun/Otto

Leader: High Warlord Rekk'tan, Claw of the Eclipse

> *"We do not conquer to rule. We conquer to prove we deserve to exist."*

Homeworld: Rrriiaa

A twilight-shrouded world of dense jungles, jagged canyons, and shadow-soaked mountains. The air itself hums with predatory intent. Rrriiaa is a deathworld where everything hunts, and only the apex survive. Lightning-storm seasons sweep across the land, igniting brutal rites of strength. The stars above are charted not for trade—but for worthy hunts.

Appearance & Physiology:

- ***Humanoid Predators:*** *7–9 feet tall, lean but monstrously strong, with sinewy musculature and facial mandibles. Their skin ranges from obsidian-black to jungle-camouflage green, and their eyes glow faint amber in infrared.*

- ***Clawed Gauntlets & Trophy Scars:*** *Their bodies bear ritual scars carved after every kill; their hands end in retractable blades or hardened claw-sheaths.*

- ***Kaefer Blades:*** *A sacred stealth weapon—curved, whisper-quiet, capable of cutting through bone without sound. Each warrior crafts theirs upon their first solo kill.*

Society & Religion:

- ***Darwinian Hierarchy:*** *Only the strong survive. Ranks are earned through ritual combat, assassination, and successful hunts. The weak are discarded—or used as prey.*

- ***Worship Through War:*** *War is not just tradition—it's spiritual purification. Their god,* ***Rraal-Tan****, is believed to watch every kill and bless only the most brutal.*

- ***Mercenary Diplomacy:*** *The Kaer'Ruun don't negotiate—they contract. If you want them on your side, pay them in skulls, spoils, or sacred prey.*

- ***Ten-Year "Bloodmoon Ceasefires":*** *Once every century, the entire species enters a ten-year sacred hiatus—a "holiday" in which no wars are fought, no hunts are allowed. This time is spent in reflection, training, and ritual storytelling… and preparing for the next slaughter.*

Gameplay Traits:

- ✅ ***Strengths:***
  - ***Stealth Specialists:*** *Elite units excel in cloaked ambushes, sabotage, and infiltration. Can disable infrastructure or assassinate enemy leaders.*
  - ***Ritual Brutality:*** *Melee units gain morale and strength the longer they are engaged in combat. Kills increase damage dealt in future battles (stacking buff).*
  - ***Mercenary Contracts:*** *Can offer their military for hire. Completing mercenary missions grants tech, resources, or rare trophies.*
  - ***Fear Aura:*** *Civilians and lesser troops may flee before battle if Kaer'Ruun forces are detected nearby.*
- ❌ ***Weaknesses:***
  - ***No Long-Term Alliances:*** *Mercenary deals are temporary. The Kaer'Ruun* ***do not do loyalty*** *unless you've bled with them and survived.*
  - ***Tech-Light, War-Heavy:*** *Focus on personal combat tech, not infrastructure. Weak economy if not compensated through contracts or conquest.*
  - ***Ceasefire Vulnerability:*** *Every century, a mandatory 10-turn ceasefire disables all offensive operations. If war is still active, massive unrest or divine punishment hits.*
  - ***Brutality Limits Diplomacy:*** *Other factions view them with distrust or terror. Difficult to negotiate lasting peace or influence-based strategies.*

Gameplay Niche:

*The Kaer'Ruun are **stealthy shock troops and sacred mercenaries**, ideal for players who prefer high-risk, high-reward raids, assassination tactics, and dominating enemies through fear and flawless execution. No empire is safe if the Kaer'Ruun are watching.*

But if you survive their hunt—you just might earn their respect.